

Day 2 Stuck Sheet: "If you see this, do this"

Before you call your instructor, try the fix on this page. Most problems today have a small, known fix.

First, try these every time:

1. Save the file (**Ctrl + S**). Refresh the browser (**F5**).
 2. Read the **red message** in the browser Console (press **F12**) or in the terminal. It usually names the file and the line number.
 3. Compare your code with the lab sheet, one line at a time.
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Part A: Installing and the terminal

Problem 1: `'node' is not recognized as an internal or external command`

Why it happens: The terminal started before Node.js was installed, so it does not know about it.

Fix:

1. Close the terminal panel.
2. **Close VS Code completely**, then open it again.
3. Open a **new** terminal (Terminal, then New Terminal) and type `node -v` again.
4. Still the same? Restart the computer once, then try again.
5. Still the same? Run the Node.js installer again and choose **Repair** if it is offered. Then repeat steps 1 to 3.

The same fix works for `git` and `npm`.

Problem 2: A red message says `running scripts is disabled on this system`

Why it happens: You are in **PowerShell**, and PowerShell blocks some scripts by default.

Fix: Switch to **Command Prompt**.

1. In the terminal panel, click the small **down arrow** next to the **+** icon.
 2. Choose **Command Prompt**.
 3. Type your command again.
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Problem 3: Windows shows "Windows protected your PC" when I run an installer

Fix: This message can appear for any installer. Only continue if the file came from the workshop folder given by your instructor.

1. Click **More info**.
2. Click **Run anyway**.

If you are not sure about the file, ask your instructor first.

Problem 4: The installer asks for an administrator password

Fix: Tell your instructor. Lab computers should allow installation with administrator rights.

Problem 5: `node setup-check.js` says `Cannot find module`

Why it happens: You are in the wrong folder. The terminal looks for the file in the current folder.

Fix:

1. Type `dir`. Do you see `setup-check.js` in the list?
 2. If not, use `cd` to go to the folder where you saved it, or copy the file into your `Workshop` folder.
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Problem 6: A line says `FAIL` in the setup check

Fix: Read the **Hint** under that line. The usual causes:

- **Node.js version is not 24:** install the Node.js 24 LTS file from the workshop folder, not another version.
 - **Git is not available:** install Git, then open a new terminal.
 - **Port 3000 is not free:** an old server is still running. Find its terminal window and press **Ctrl + C**.
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Part B: JavaScript and the Notes Board

Problem 7: I click "Add note" and the page just reloads

Why it happens: `app.js` is not running, so the browser uses the default form behaviour.

Fix:

1. At the end of `index.html` , is there a line `<script src="js/app.js"></script>` just before `</body>` ?
 2. Is the file really at `notes-board\js\app.js` ? Check the folder name and the file name.
 3. Press **F12**, open the **Console** tab, and read any red error.
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Problem 8: Console says `Cannot read properties of null (reading 'addEventListener')`

Why it happens: JavaScript looked for an element by its `id` , and the page has no element with that `id` . Usually the `id` in the HTML and the `id` in the JavaScript are spelled differently.

Fix:

1. Look at the line number in the error.
 2. Check the `id` inside the quotes of `getElementById("...")` .
 3. Check the same `id` in `index.html` . The spelling must match exactly, including `-` and capital letters.
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Problem 9: Console says `Uncaught SyntaxError`

Why it happens: Something is missing in the code, for example a closing `}` or `)` or a quote.

Fix:

1. Look at the line number in the error.
 2. Check that line and the line above it.
 3. In VS Code, click next to a `{` or `(` . VS Code highlights its matching partner. If nothing is highlighted, the partner is missing.
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Problem 10: Console says `something is not defined`

Why it happens: A name is spelled differently from where it was created, for example `notesList` and `noteslist` . JavaScript is **case sensitive**.

Fix: Search for the name in your file (**Ctrl + F**) and make every copy match.

Problem 11: My notes show, but there are no buttons or the page looks plain

Fix:

1. Did you paste the Day 2 CSS block at the end of `style.css` ?
 2. Save `style.css` , and refresh with **F5**.
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Problem 12: The About page is empty, or it shows nothing from my details

Fix:

1. Are both script lines at the end of `about.html` ? Is `student-details.js` **before** `about.js` ?
 2. Open the Console (F12). Read the red error.
 3. Did you leave `studentDetails` values empty? Empty values are hidden on purpose. Type something and refresh.
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Part C: The first server

Problem 13: `Error: listen EADDRINUSE: address already in use :::3000`

Why it happens: Another program is already using port 3000. Often it is your own old server, still running.

Fix:

1. Find the terminal where the old server runs. Press **Ctrl + C**.
 2. Check all terminal tabs in VS Code. The panel may show several terminals.
 3. Run `node hello.js` again.
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Problem 14: The browser says "This site can't be reached" at localhost:3000

Fix:

1. Is the server still running? The terminal must show `Server is running...` and must not show a prompt.
 2. Is the address exactly `http://localhost:3000` ? It must start with `http://` and not `https://` .
 3. Did the server stop with an error? Read the terminal and fix the error first.
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Problem 15: `Cannot find module 'C:\...\hello.js'`

Fix: You are in the wrong folder. Type `cd hello-server` (from `Workshop`), then try again. Use `dir` to see the files in your current folder.

Problem 16: I changed `hello.js` but the browser shows the old message

Fix: A running server does not reload by itself. Press **Ctrl + C** to stop it, run `node hello.js` again, and refresh the browser.

I am far behind

This is okay.

1. Copy the **done** folder for Day 2 from your instructor. Read it and compare it to your own work.
2. Tomorrow's starter folder has everything from Day 2, so you can join Day 3 on time.
3. Installing Node.js and Git is the most important part of today. Make sure `node setup-check.js` shows four PASS lines before you leave.